TOPIC 4 · CREATE MICROSOFT 365 AGENTS FOR BUSINESSES
LAB 12 THEME · AGENT CONFIGURATION

Lab 12 — Configure Instructions Knowledge and Starter Prompts

Maps to	LO4: design a staff training plan for Microsoft Loop and Copilot Studio while configuring, testing and sharing a bounded Microsoft 365 business agent.
Duration	30 minutes
Tools	Microsoft 365 Copilot Agent Builder · SharePoint or OneDrive · Microsoft Loop · Word · Excel
Mock data	data/Northstar_Work_Orders.xlsx, data/knowledge/Northstar_Maintenance_Policy.docx, data/knowledge/Northstar_Verified_Snapshot.docx, data/knowledge/Northstar_Work_Orders.xlsx, data/knowledge/Northstar_Staff_Enablement_Plan.docx, data/knowledge/Northstar_Knowledge_Inventory.csv, data/knowledge/Northstar_Agent_Owner_Config_Register.csv
Lab files	data/templates/Northstar_Agent_Instructions.txt (Reviewed instruction text); data/templates/Northstar_Agent_Test_Matrix.csv (Eight-case test matrix)
Course	Enhance Work Productivity with Microsoft 365 Copilot (TGS-2024043856) · v9.0
Prompts	https://tertiarycourses.github.io/TGS-2024043856-Enhance-Work-Productivity-with-Microsoft-365-Copilot/prompts/#lab-12

Goal

Private configured agent or evidence-complete configuration record.

What You Will Do

Configure the private agent with precise instructions, selected knowledge and starter prompts. Verify the visible configuration before creating it.

What You Will Build

Private configured agent or evidence-complete configuration record.

Prerequisites

- Microsoft 365 account with Copilot available in Word, Excel, PowerPoint and Outlook. Availability depends on the assigned licence and tenant settings; confirm access with the trainer before class.
- Desktop Excel on Windows or Mac is recommended; save working copies to your assigned OneDrive course folder with AutoSave on. Do not overwrite the supplied input.
- Download this whole lab folder. All files are synthetic; Northstar-v9 is your own learner output folder.
- Microsoft 365 Copilot Agent Builder access in the assigned tenant. Availability depends on licence and admin policy; use the supplied configuration-and-test route when unavailable.

Data note

Northstar Water Services is fictional. Use the verified 120-row baseline and fixed reporting date 30 September 2026. Current assignments are evidence; proposals are not approved. Agent labs use retrieval, configuration, testing and supported sharing only; they never claim external-service actions.

Steps

Step 1. Open the Lab 11 draft. On Configure, enter the concise description and complete bounded instructions. Keep within the documented 8,000-character instruction limit.

Step 2. Add only approved Northstar knowledge. Prefer already-permissioned SharePoint or OneDrive items. Record the different access implication if using embedded files.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

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AGENT BUILDER - INSTRUCTIONS:
You are the Northstar Operations Knowledge Agent for a fictional training company. Use only
the configured Northstar knowledge sources for operational claims. Cite the source title in
every answer containing a date, work-order count, status definition or assignment. Treat 30
September 2026 as the fixed reporting date for the supplied baseline. Distinguish current from
proposed assignment. If evidence is absent or conflicting, say UNKNOWN and name the missing
source or conflict. Do not invent causes, customer impact, safety impact, approval or live
state. Do not send email, modify files, change work orders, approve assignments or claim an
external action was completed. Agent Builder does not author external-service actions; route
such requests to an authorised human workflow or separately governed Copilot Studio solution.
Keep answers concise, include Sources, and name the human review owner.
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Step 3. Turn off broad web search for this internal scenario when policy permits. Record actual state because Agent Builder cannot fully block general AI knowledge.

Step 4. Add four supported starter prompts.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

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AGENT BUILDER - STARTER PROMPTS:
1. Summarise the verified 30 September 2026 backlog and cite the source. 2. Explain backlog
and overdue definitions. 3. Compare current with proposed assignment without approving a
change. 4. Give a staff practice plan from the enablement guide.
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Step 5. Use Try it for one supported and one missing-evidence question. Refine if the answer omits a citation or invents a fact.

Step 6. Select Create only after both preview tests pass. Record private state, owner, instruction version and knowledge list.

Sample Prompts

Use the app labelled for each prompt (or adapt it). Name the table and columns, state the output, and always verify the result. Use the linked prompts web page for one-click Copy buttons.

Copy-ready prompts: https://tertiarycourses.github.io/TGS-2024043856-Enhance-Work-Productivity-with-Microsoft-365-Copilot/prompts/#lab-12

#	Purpose	Prompt
1	Configure	Configure the Northstar Operations Agent with the reviewed instruction text, four approved knowledge items and four starter prompts; keep the agent private.
2	Preview	Run one cited backlog question and one missing-cause question; the second must return UNKNOWN.

Test It

Check	Expected result
Instructions	Purpose, citations, UNKNOWN and prohibited actions explicit.
Knowledge	Items match inventory and existing permissions.
Prompts	Four prompts are supported by knowledge.
Preview	Grounded and UNKNOWN answers pass before Create.

Checkpoint

If you fell behind, use data/checkpoints/Northstar_Verified_Checkpoint.xlsx and data/checkpoints/Northstar_Verified_Snapshot.docx. Record checkpoint used in Prompt_Log; then perform this lab, rather than claiming the checkpoint as your output.

Troubleshooting

If this happens	Fix
Copilot cannot find the source	Use the app file picker to select the actual OneDrive file. A typed local path or a different app chat is not shared context. If needed copy only the verified snapshot into the current app.
A total disagrees with Control	Clear dashboard filters to All, check table extent and duplicate IDs, recalculate, then compare definitions and reporting date. Reconcile before continuing.
The named feature is missing	Confirm the correct assigned account, English display language and app version. Use the stated manual practice route; record feature unavailable. This is not evidence that a native skill ran.

Challenge

Run one additional adversarial prompt and explain which instruction or knowledge boundary controlled the response.

Reflection

Which evidence proves the output is correct, and which decision still needs a person?